In Her Own Words

Dr. Madhulika Singh on Leadership, Purpose and the Work That Matters

From rural healthcare camps to institution building, Dr. Madhulika Singh speaks with rare clarity about what it truly means to lead.



Q1 Healthcare leadership is often associated with metro centres and corporate hospitals. You chose a different path. What guided that choice?

I have always believed that the measure of healthcare is not how well it serves those who already have access, but how far it reaches toward those who do not. When I look at Uttar Pradesh and the distance between most specialist care and most people, the direction becomes obvious. It was never a sacrifice of ambition. It was ambition, directed where it was actually needed.

Q2 During Covid-19 you ensured care reached patients in their homes, at a time of extraordinary strain. How did you lead through that period?

Crisis is a test of what an institution actually stands for. We decided early that our patients would not be left to manage alone simply because the hospital was overwhelmed. We extended our reach into homes and communities that had no other recourse.

While continuing to serve others throughout that time, I lost my husband, who was also a doctor. He was tirelessly serving patients when he himself contracted Covid-19 and tragically could not survive. It was an extremely tough and emotionally challenging time. Despite everything, we continued our commitment to serving people.

Q3 Ayushman Bharat implementation brought free treatment to hundreds from economically weaker sections. What does that teach women leaders about integrity and impact?

Any scheme only works if the person administering it is committed to its intent, not merely its compliance. When we implemented Ayushman Bharat, we were making a promise to patients who had no other safety net. The integrity with which you execute the smallest operational decision is the same integrity that will define your largest institutional legacy.

Q4 What inspired you to move from clinical work to founding academic institutions?

There is a moment when every leader realises her hands can only do so much, and that the more important work is multiplying capable, committed hands in the field. Bodhisattva University was born from the recognition that Uttar Pradesh's healthcare future depends on better-trained, values-driven doctors, nurses and paramedics. That is the investment that compounds.

Dr. Madhulika Singh
Chancellor
Bodhisattva University
KNS Memorial Institute of Medical Sciences
KNS Hospital
KNS Paramedical

Q5 What would you tell a young woman who wants to lead in healthcare but is uncertain of her path?

Stay close to the need, keep your standards uncompromisingly high, and do not wait for conditions to be perfect. Purpose is not something you find. It is something you build, one honest decision at a time.

Dr. Madhulika Singh does not speak about leaving a legacy — she is too busy building one, institution by institution, patient by patient, one trained hand at a time.